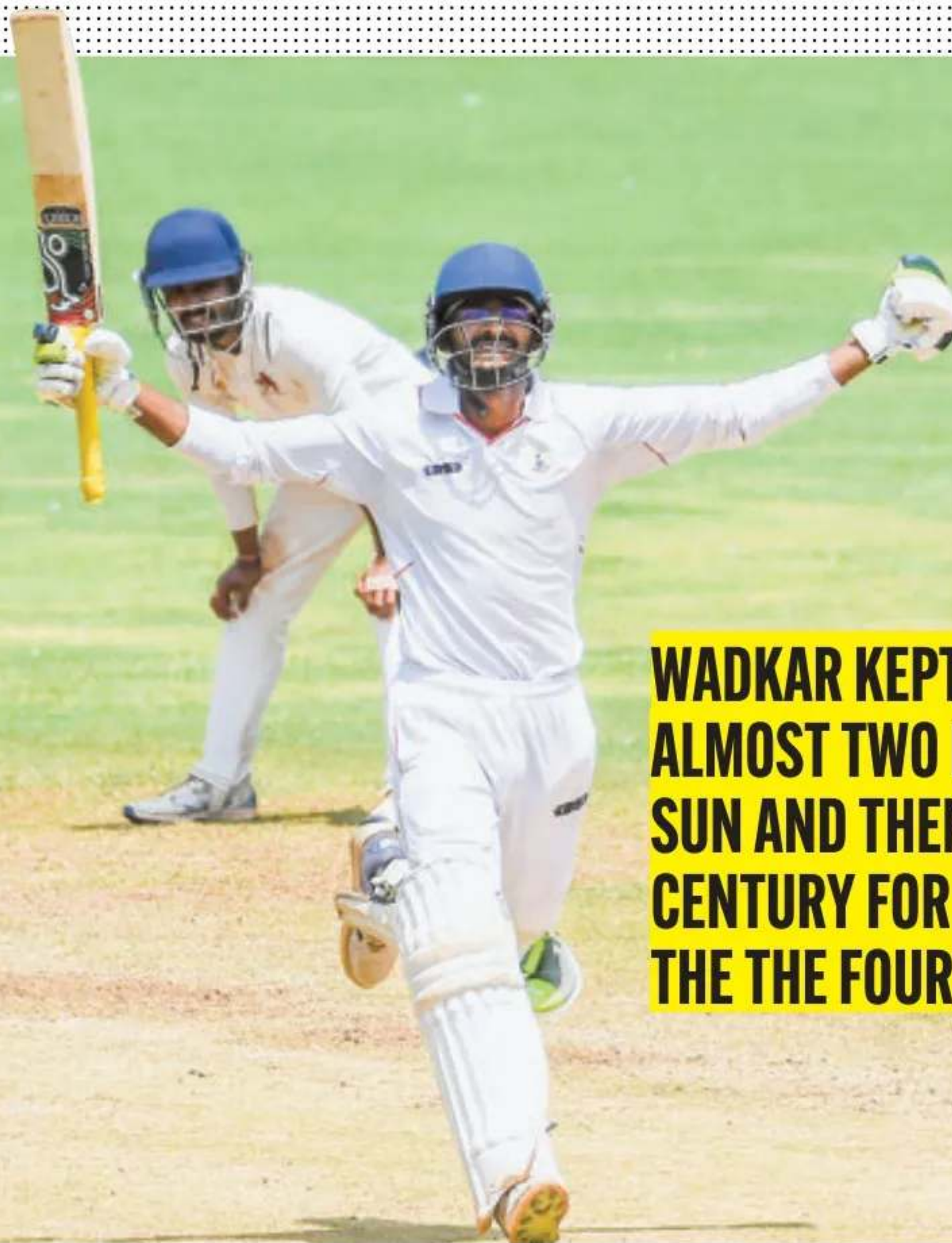




WADKAR KEPT WICKETS FOR ALMOST TWO DAYS IN THE HOT SUN AND THEN SCORED A CENTURY FOR VIDARBHA IN THE THE FOURTH INNINGS

match, and in this game, taking the wrong decision to bat first after winning the toss was the biggest turning point. One could argue that this could have been conveyed to the association in the confidential report given at the end of the tournament. But if the coach is asked by the media and he has given his frank assessment, then that should be taken on board rather than trying to stamp on him as being an outsider. To suggest that he thought like a Mumbaikar and spoke like a Mumbaikar is completely missing the point that Mumbai have won the Ranji Trophy almost more times than the rest of the states put together.

Tamil Nadu, despite producing some of the most brilliant cricketers for India, have won the

Ranji Trophy only twice, and maybe, just maybe, a bit of thinking like Mumbaikars may help them win it more often. Don't forget that this season Tamil Nadu qualified for the knockouts after six years, and they almost put it across Mumbai in that semifinal. Mumbai cricketers may not have fancy degrees in education, but over the years, they have shown cricketing intelligence and commonsense, which often make the difference between winning and losing.

How one longs for the day when Indians will support Indian cricketers and those in the cricketing ecosystem, like the Australians, South Africans, and English cricketers, support each other.



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